

Apart from the regular media player functions (Playlists, Media Library, ripping music, burning to CD/DVD, etc.) iTunes also has several nifty features that make it an absolute pleasure to use.

Syncing

The software syncs seamlessly with the iPod and other portable devices. The Windows version of iTunes, however, can only sync with the iPod. One can transfer selected Playlists to the iPod, and once connected, the software will automatically make the necessary additions/removals to the device.

Podcasting

iTunes allows users to search and download a variety of podcasts onto one's computer. You can also configure the software to check for new podcasts and delete old ones periodically. These options are available by clicking **Edit > Preferences**. The latest release of iTunes also has support for video podcasts and RSS. Users simply need to enter the feed URL in the pop up menu that arises when one clicks **Advanced > Subscribe to Podcast**. One can also access streaming audio and video by entering the URL in the **Advanced > Open Stream** menu.

Party Shuffle

This is a nifty tool meant essentially as a quick Playlist creating DJ aid. The Party Shuffle Playlist randomly selects tracks from the Media Library, or other Playlists. One can also edit the tracks in this Playlist by simply dragging and dropping files into it.



Edit the Party Shuffle Playlist on the fly

10.3.2 Musicmatch Jukebox

Media player using veterans will recall fondly the times when the most effective CD ripping software was Musicmatch. Before iTunes